HISTORY • RAS PRELIMS NOTES

Indian History

Ancient, medieval and modern India - Indus to 1857, the freedom struggle and nation building up to 2000

Inside these notes

- Dynasty, date and leader tables, the way RAS asks them
- Art, architecture, Bhakti-Sufi and knowledge system covered fully
- Memory hooks and exam traps in every chapter

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Notes made for RAS aspirants - simple language, connected concepts, PYQ-based facts.

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Chapter 1: Indus Valley & Vedic Age

The Indus Valley Civilisation (c. 3300-1300 BCE)

The Indus Valley Civilisation (IVC), also called the **Harappan Civilisation** after its first discovered site, is India's earliest urban culture. Its mature phase ran from about **2600 to 1900 BCE**. It covered a larger area than contemporary Egypt and Mesopotamia, stretching from **Sutkagendor** (west, in Balochistan) to **Alamgirpur** (east, in Uttar Pradesh), and from **Manda** (north, in Jammu) to **Daimabad** (south, in Maharashtra). No other Bronze Age culture matches its uniformity in town planning, bricks, weights and seals.

MEMORY HOOK: Remember the four corners as "S-A-M-D" - Sutkagendor, Alamgirpur, Manda, Daimabad. RAS loves asking the westernmost or easternmost site.

Major Sites and What Was Found There

Site	Location / River	Key Findings
Harappa	Punjab (Pakistan), River Ravi	First site excavated (1921, Daya Ram Sahni); granaries, two rows of six granaries; coffin burial
Mohenjo-daro	Sindh (Pakistan), River Indus	Largest site of the early excavations; Great Bath, Great Granary, bronze "Dancing Girl", bearded priest figure, seal of Pashupati
Lothal	Gujarat, River Bhogava	Dockyard, warehouse, rice husk evidence, fire altars, double burial
Dholavira	Gujarat, Kutch region	Divided into **three parts** (citadel, middle town, lower town); huge water reservoirs; a large signboard inscription
Rakhigarhi	Haryana, near River Ghaggar	One of the **largest** Harappan sites; evidence of granary, burials and craft activity
Kalibangan	Rajasthan, River Ghaggar	Ploughed field surface, fire altars, both citadel and lower town fortified, wooden drain
Banawali	Haryana	Barley grains, town plan with radial streets
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	Only city **without a citadel**; bead-making and shell-working centre
Surkotada	Gujarat	Evidence claimed for horse bones
Kot Diji	Sindh (Pakistan)	Pre-Harappan (early Harappan) layer below the mature phase

PYQ PATTERN: The site-to-finding match is the single most repeated IVC question pattern. Learn "Lothal = dockyard", "Kalibangan = ploughed field + fire altars", "Dholavira = three divisions + reservoirs", "Chanhudaro = no citadel".

Town Planning: The Hallmark of the IVC

- Cities were divided into a raised western **citadel** (for rulers/priests) and a lower eastern town (for common people). Dholavira and Lothal are exceptions in layout.
- Streets followed a **grid pattern**, cutting each other at right angles.
- Houses were built of **burnt bricks** of a standard ratio (1:2:4). Baked brick use on this scale was unmatched in the ancient world.
- A covered **drainage system** ran from houses to street drains - the best sanitation of the Bronze Age.
- The **Great Bath** at Mohenjo-daro (about 11.9 m x 7 m x 2.4 m deep) was probably used for ritual bathing; its floor was made watertight with bitumen.
- Granaries stored surplus grain, showing organised collection and redistribution.

Society, Economy and Religion

- Society appears **egalitarian** compared to Egypt or Mesopotamia: no grand royal tombs or temples have been found.
- Main crops: **wheat and barley**; rice at Lothal and Rangpur; cotton was first grown here - the Greeks later called cotton "sindon" after Sindh.
- Trade links reached **Mesopotamia**, where Harappan seals are found; Mesopotamian texts call the Indus region **"Meluha"**. Imports included gold, silver, copper and lapis lazuli (from Afghanistan).
- Weights followed a **binary and decimal system** (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32...); cubical weights were made of chert.
- The script has around **400 pictographic signs**, written right to left (boustrophedon in longer texts). It remains **undeciphered**.
- Religious life: worship of a **Mother Goddess** (many terracotta figurines), a male deity on a seal surrounded by animals (called **Pashupati**, a proto-Shiva), trees (pipal), animals (humped bull, unicorn) and fire altars at Lothal and Kalibangan.
- **No temple** structures and **no evidence of a standing army** or large-scale warfare have been found.

EXAM TRAP: "The Indus people did not know iron." Iron came much later (early 1st millennium BCE). They also did **not** build temples - do not confuse the Great Bath with a temple.

Why Did It Decline? (c. 1900 BCE onwards)

There is no single accepted cause; scholars suggest a combination:

- Gradual **climatic change** and reduced rainfall; rivers shifting or drying (the Ghaggar-Hakra system weakened).
- Floods and river course changes at sites like Mohenjo-daro.
- Overuse of land, deforestation and declining soil fertility.
- Decline of trade with Mesopotamia after about 1900 BCE.
- The old theory of an "Aryan invasion" destroying the cities (Mortimer Wheeler) is **not accepted** today; the decline looks gradual and regional, with people moving eastward and southward.

MEMORY HOOK: Decline = slow fading, not sudden destruction. Cities were abandoned one by one over centuries - that is the modern consensus.

The Vedic Age (c. 1500-600 BCE)

The **Rigveda**, composed roughly between **1500 and 1000 BCE**, is the earliest Vedic text. The people called themselves **Arya**. Historians divide the period into the Early Vedic (Rigvedic) phase and the Later Vedic phase (c. 1000-600 BCE), based on the other three Vedas and the prose texts composed later.

Structure of Vedic Literature

- **Four Vedas**: Rigveda (hymns to gods), Samaveda (melodies for chanting), Yajurveda (ritual formulas), Atharvaveda (spells, charms and everyday life).
- Each Veda has four layers: **Samhita** (hymns), **Brahmanas** (ritual explanation), **Aranyakas** (forest texts), **Upanishads** (philosophy - soul, Brahman, rebirth).
- The Rigveda has **10 mandalas and 1,028 hymns**; the **Gayatri Mantra** (dedicated to Savitri) is in the third mandala, composed by Vishvamitra.
- Six **Vedangas** (limbs of the Veda) aided study: Shiksha (pronunciation), Kalpa (ritual), Vyakarana (grammar), Nirukta (word meanings), Chhanda (metre), Jyotisha (astronomy).
- Later tradition added the **Upavedas**, epics (Ramayana, Mahabharata) and Puranas.

EXAM TRAP: The Upanishads are also called **Vedanta** (the end of the Veda) - both because they come last and because they contain the highest philosophy. The famous phrase **"Satyameva Jayate"** is from the **Mundaka Upanishad**.

Early Vedic vs Later Vedic: The Big Comparison

Aspect	Early Vedic (1500-1000 BCE)	Later Vedic (1000-600 BCE)
Region	Sapta Sindhu - land of seven rivers, mainly Punjab	Ganga-Yamuna Doab and middle Ganga plain (Kuru, Panchala, Videha)
Polity	Tribal; chief (**rajan**) elected/checked by assemblies; no hereditary kingship in full form	Territorial kingdoms; kingship became hereditary; king performed great sacrifices (Rajasuya, Ashvamedha, Vajapeya)
Assemblies	**Sabha** (elders) and **Samiti** (larger folk assembly) were powerful; Vidatha was the oldest	Sabha and Samiti lost power as kings grew strong
Taxes	**Bali** - a voluntary gift/tribute to the chief	Bali became a regular compulsory tax; officials like Sangrihitri (treasurer) appear
Society	Varna flexible, based on work; women respected - women hymn-composers (Lopamudra, Gargi, Maitreyi belong to this tradition)	Varna became rigid and birth-based; women's status declined; child marriage and sati references begin at the margins
Economy	Pastoral - cattle were wealth; the word **gavishthi** meant a fight for cows	Agriculture became primary; **iron** (called Krishna Ayas, "black metal") used for axes and ploughshares
Religion	Gods of nature: **Indra** (most praised, 250 hymns), Agni, Varuna, Soma; simple prayers, no temples or idols	Sacrifices became elaborate and costly; new gods rose - **Prajapati** (creator), Vishnu and Rudra gained importance; priests (Brahmanas) dominated ritual
Key Texts	Rigveda Samhita	Other Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads

PYQ PATTERN: "Which metal was known to the Later Vedic people but not the Rigvedic people?" - Answer: **iron**. Similarly, rice (vrihi) and large-scale agriculture belong to the Later Vedic phase.

Vedic Gods and Society in Brief

- **Indra** was the war god and rain-bringer, called **Purandara** (destroyer of forts).
- The king's main officials in the Rigvedic age: **Purohita** (priest), **Senani** (army chief), **Gramani** (village head).
- The family was patriarchal; the basic unit was the **kula**.
- The four varnas are first named together in the **Purusha Sukta** of the tenth mandala of the Rigveda - Brahmana (mouth), Kshatriya/Rajanya (arms), Vaishya (thighs), Shudra (feet).

MEMORY HOOK: Purusha Sukta = the only Rigvedic hymn that lists all four varnas. Tenth mandala is the latest layer of the Rigveda.

Chapter 2: The 6th Century BCE - Buddhism, Jainism & Ajivakas

Setting the Stage: The Sixteen Mahajanapadas

By the 6th century BCE, northern India had **16 Mahajanapadas** (great kingdoms/republics) listed in the Buddhist text **Anguttara Nikaya**. Most were monarchies, but a few were republics (**ganasanghas**) like the Vajji confederacy of the Lichchhavis at Vaishali and the Mallas.

Mahajanapada	Capital	Note
Magadha	Rajagriha (later Pataliputra)	Rose to supremacy; rich iron mines and fertile land
Kosala	Shravasti	King Prasenjit was Buddha's contemporary
Vatsa	Kaushambi	King Udayana famous in literature
Avanti	Ujjain	King Pradyota; strong western power
Anga	Champa	Annexed by Magadha - the first conquest
Kashi	Varanasi	Among the oldest; absorbed by Kosala
Vajji (Vrijji)	Vaishali	Lichchhavi republic - world's early republican system
Malla	Kushinagar / Pava	Republic; Buddha died at Kushinagar
Gandhara	Taxila	North-west; famous university town
Kamboja	Rajapura	North-west frontier region

The Rise of Magadha

- **Haryanka dynasty**: **Bimbisara** (contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira) annexed Anga and used marriage alliances; his son **Ajatashatru** defeated the Lichchhavis after a long war and fortified Pataliputra.

- **Shishunaga dynasty** followed, then the **Nanda dynasty** (Mahapadma Nanda) built a huge army and treasury before Chandragupta Maurya overthrew them.
- Magadha won because of fertile alluvial land, **iron mines** nearby, elephants from eastern forests, and able rulers - not any single cause.

EXAM TRAP: Bimbisara and Ajatashatru belong to the **Haryanka** dynasty, NOT the Nandas. The Nandas come just before the Mauryas.

Buddhism: The Buddha and His Teaching

Siddhartha Gautama, the Buddha (563-483 BCE by traditional dating), was born at **Lumbini** (in present Nepal), in the Shakya clan of Kapilavastu.

Life Events of the Buddha

Event	Place	Detail
Birth	Lumbini	Born to Suddhodana and Maya; mother died soon after, raised by Gautami
Great Renunciation (Mahabhinishkramana)	Kapilavastu	Left home at 29 after seeing an old man, a sick man, a corpse and an ascetic
Enlightenment (Sambodhi)	Bodh Gaya (Uruvela), under a pipal (Bodhi) tree	At age 35, on the banks of the Niranjana river
First Sermon (Dharmachakra Pravartana)	Sarnath (Deer Park, Mrigadava)	To his five former companions
Death (Mahaparinirvana)	Kushinagar	At age 80, among the Mallas

MEMORY HOOK: Four places fix the Buddha's life - **Lumbini (birth), Bodh Gaya (enlightenment), Sarnath (first sermon), Kushinagar (death)**. The chain "L-B-S-K" in this order solves many questions.

Core Teachings

- **Four Noble Truths**: life is full of suffering (dukkha); suffering has a cause (desire/craving, tanha); suffering can end; the path to end it is the **Eightfold Path**.
- **Eightfold Path (Ashtangika Marga)**: right view, right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right concentration.
- **Pratitya Samutpada** (dependent origination): everything arises from causes - the philosophical core.
- Buddha denied a creator God and the permanence of the soul (**anatta** - no eternal soul), rejected Vedic ritual and varna by birth, and taught in **Pali**, the language of the people.
- The Buddhist order is the **Sangha**; followers follow the **Triratna** - Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha. Women were admitted to the Sangha (Mahapajapati Gautami was the first bhikkhuni) after Ananda's request.
- Sacred texts: the **Tripitaka** - Vinaya Pitaka (monastic rules), Sutta Pitaka (sermons), Abhidhamma Pitaka (philosophy), written in Pali.

Buddhist Councils

Council	Place	Patron / President	Result
First (483 BCE)	Rajagriha	Ajatashatru / Mahakassapa	Teachings recollected by Ananda and Upali
Second (383 BCE)	Vaishali	Kalashoka	First split into Sthaviravadins and Mahasanghikas
Third (c. 250 BCE)	Pataliputra	Ashoka / Moggaliputta Tissa	Abhidhamma compiled; missions sent abroad
Fourth (1st century CE)	Kundalvana, Kashmir	Kanishka / Vasumitra	Formal split into **Hinayana and Mahayana**

Jainism: Mahavira and the Tirthankaras

Jain tradition counts **24 Tirthankaras** (ford-makers). The first was **Rishabhanatha (Adinath)** and the 23rd was **Parshvanatha**, who taught four vows. **Vardhamana Mahavira** (599-527 BCE by tradition), the 24th, was born at **Kundagrama** near Vaishali; he attained omniscience (kaivalya) at **Jrimbhikagrama** and died at **Pavapuri**.

Mahavira's Teachings

- **Five vows (Panch Mahavrata)**: Ahimsa (non-violence), Satya (truth), Asteya (non-stealing), Brahmacharya (chastity - added by Mahavira), Aparigraha (non-possession).
- **Triratna of Jainism**: Right Faith (Samyak Darshana), Right Knowledge (Samyak Jnana), Right Conduct (Samyak Charitra).
- Jainism believes the soul (jiva) is bound by karma as matter; liberation (moksha) comes by stopping and shedding karma through effort - no creator God.
- **Anekantavada** (many-sidedness of truth) and **Syadvada** (doctrine of "maybe", seven-fold judgement) are Jainism's famous philosophical gifts.
- Jain texts are in **Prakrit** (Ardhamagadhi); the canon is called the **Agamas**. A Jain council at **Pataliputra** (3rd century BCE) and later at **Valabhi** (5th-6th century CE) compiled them.

The Two Jain Sects

- **Digambaras** ("sky-clad"): monks go naked; believe women cannot attain liberation directly; associated with **Bhadrabahu**, who led a migration to Karnataka (Shravanabelagola) during a famine.
- **Shvetambaras** ("white-clad"): monks wear white clothes; the canon is preserved by them; associated with **Sthulabhadra**, who stayed in Magadha.
- The split is traditionally dated to the famine in Magadha around the end of the 4th century BCE (time of Chandragupta Maurya).

EXAM TRAP: Chandragupta Maurya, in his last years, is said to have **abdicated and become a Jain monk** under Bhadrabahu and died at Shravanabelagola (sallekhana). This is a Jain tradition RAS frequently tests.

The Ajivikas

- Founded by **Makkhali Gosala**, a contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira, who had earlier been Mahavira's companion.
- Core doctrine: **Niyati (absolute fate/determinism)** - everything is predetermined; human effort cannot change destiny. This is the exact opposite of the karma-effort doctrines of Buddhism

and Jainism.

- Ajivikas lived as naked ascetics in communities; they received royal patronage later (the **Barabar caves** in Bihar, among India's oldest rock-cut caves, were donated by **Ashoka** to the Ajivikas).
- The sect survived for many centuries in south India but eventually died out.

Comparison Table: Buddhism, Jainism, Ajivika

Point	Buddhism	Jainism	Ajivika
Founder (historical)	Gautama Buddha	Vardhamana Mahavira (24th Tirthankara)	Makkhali Gosala
Soul	Denies eternal soul (anatta)	Soul exists, bound by karma	Soul exists but all is fated
Path	Middle Path, Eightfold Path	Three Jewels, five great vows, severe austerity	Niyati - fate rules all, effort useless
Language of texts	Pali	Prakrit (Ardhamagadhi)	Prakrit (texts lost)
Place of founder's death	Kushinagar	Pavapuri	Shravasti (tradition)

PYQ PATTERN: Why did these movements arise? Common causes RAS expects: reaction against costly Vedic rituals and priestly dominance, varna rigidity hurting Vaishya and Kshatriya ambitions, spread of iron-based agriculture needing ahimsa for cattle wealth, and royal patronage from Magadha's kings.

Chapter 3: Maurya & Post-Maurya Dynasties

The Mauryan Empire (c. 322-185 BCE)

Chandragupta Maurya founded the empire around **322 BCE** by overthrowing the Nandas, guided by **Kautilya (Chanakya/Vishnugupta)**, author of the **Arthashastra**. Chandragupta defeated the Greek governor **Seleucus Nicator** (c. 305 BCE), who sent the ambassador **Megasthenes** to Pataliputra; Megasthenes' **Indica** describes Mauryan India (the original is lost; fragments survive in Greek writers).

The Three Great Mauryan Rulers

Ruler	Reign (approx.)	Key Facts
Chandragupta Maurya	322-298 BCE	Founder; defeated Seleucus; Jain tradition - died at Shravanabelagola
Bindusara	298-273 BCE	Called **Amitraghata** (slayer of enemies); Deimachus was the Greek envoy at his court
Ashoka	273-232 BCE	Crowned 269 BCE; fought the **Kalinga War (261 BCE)**; adopted Buddhism; patron of the Third Council

Ashoka's Edicts and Dhamma

- Ashoka was the **first Indian ruler to speak directly to his people through inscriptions** - over 30 edicts on rocks and polished sandstone pillars.
- The edicts are mostly in **Prakrit language and Brahmi script**; in the north-west (Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra) they use **Kharoshthi script**; a Kandahar edict is bilingual in Greek and Aramaic.

- **James Prinsep deciphered Brahmi in 1837**, unlocking Ashoka's inscriptions.
- The pillar edicts and the lion capital of the **Sarnath pillar** (now India's national emblem) show Mauryan polish and craft at its peak.
- **Dhamma (Dharma)** was not Buddhism itself but a code of social ethics: respect parents and elders, kindness to servants and slaves, non-violence to animals (he banned royal hunts and many animal killings), tolerance among sects, and welfare works - planting trees, digging wells, building rest houses and hospitals for men and animals.
- Ashoka sent emissaries (duta) to Sri Lanka - his son **Mahinda** and daughter **Sanghamitta** (per Sri Lankan chronicles) - and to the Hellenistic kings named in his edicts (Antiochus, Ptolemy and others).

EXAM TRAP: Dhamma = moral code for all subjects, NOT the Buddhist religion forced on everyone. Ashoka remained personally Buddhist but ruled as a tolerant emperor. Also: the **Rummindei (Lumbini) pillar edict** records his visit to Buddha's birthplace and a tax reduction for the village.

Mauryan Administration

- Highly centralised: the king at Pataliputra, advised by ministers (mantris); an elaborate **spy system** is described in the Arthashastra.
- Empire divided into provinces (e.g., Taxila in the north-west, Ujjain in the west, Tosali in the east, Suvarnagiri in the south) ruled by princes (kumara/aryaputra).
- Districts under officials; villages under a **gramika**. Megasthenes describes Pataliputra's municipal administration by committees.
- Army and bureaucracy were paid in cash; land tax (**bhaga**) was the main revenue - usually **1/6th of the produce** (Arthashastra allows higher rates in fertile regions).
- Famous officers: **Samaharta** (chief revenue collector), **Sannidhata** (treasurer), **Senapati** (commander), **Amatya** (high official/civil servant class).

Post-Mauryan India (c. 185 BCE - 300 CE)

After the last Maurya, Brihadratha, was killed by his commander **Pushyamitra Shunga** (185 BCE), several regional powers ruled. Pushyamitra's **Shunga** dynasty was followed in Magadha by the short-lived **Kanva** dynasty (from 73 BCE).

Satavahanas of the Deccan

- The **Satavahanas** (Andhras of the Puranas) ruled the Deccan from about the 1st century BCE to the 3rd century CE; early centre at **Pratishthana (Paithan)** on the Godavari.
- **Gautamiputra Satakarni** (c. 106-130 CE) was their greatest king - he defeated the Shaka ruler Nahapana and restored the dynasty's power; his achievements are recorded in the **Nasik inscription of his mother Gautami Balashri**.
- Satavahana society shows a rare feature: kings used **metronymics** (mother's name, e.g., Gautamiputra, Vasishthiputra).
- They were the **first Indian rulers to issue lead coins** on a large scale and gave land grants to Brahmanas and Buddhist monks; the rock-cut caves of Karle and the stupa art of Amaravati flourished in their realm.

Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushans

- The **Indo-Greeks** (Bactrian Greeks) ruled the north-west; the most famous was **Menander (Milinda, c. 165-145 BCE)**, whose dialogue with the monk Nagasena forms the Buddhist text **Milinda Panha** (Questions of Milinda). Indo-Greeks issued the first gold coins and the first coins

bearing rulers' portraits in India.

- The **Shakas** (Scythians) followed; **Rudradaman I** (c. 130-150 CE) issued the famous **Junagadh inscription** - the first long inscription in chaste Sanskrit - recording the repair of the **Sudarshana lake** dam (originally built under Chandragupta Maurya).
- The **Kushans**, a branch of the Yueh-chi tribe from Central Asia, built an empire from Central Asia to the Ganga plain.

Kanishka and the Kushan Age

- **Kanishka** (from 78 CE by the most accepted view) was the greatest Kushan; his accession is traditionally linked with the start of the **Shaka era (78 CE)**, still used in India's national calendar.
- His empire had two capitals - **Purushapura (Peshawar)** and **Mathura**. He built a great stupa and monastery at Peshawar.
- He patronised the **Fourth Buddhist Council** at Kundalvana (Kashmir), presided over by Vasumitra, where Buddhism formally divided into **Mahayana** and **Hinayana**.
- His court included **Ashvaghosha** (author of Buddhacharita), **Nagarjuna** (founder of Madhyamika philosophy), **Charaka** (physician, Charaka Samhita) and the minister Mathara.
- Kushan age art: the **Gandhara school** (Greco-Roman style, grey schist stone, made the first Buddha images in human form, region: north-west) and the **Mathura school** (indigenous, red sandstone, produced Buddha, Jain and Hindu images). The **Amaravati school** in the south favoured white marble and narrative panels.
- Kushans issued abundant **gold coins** of high purity - trade with Rome along the Silk Route enriched the empire; India exported spices, cotton and ivory.

MEMORY HOOK: "Gandhara = Greek touch, western stone; Mathura = purely Indian, red stone." And Kanishka's four markers: 78 CE era, 4th Council, Mahayana split, Gandhara + Mathura art.

PYQ PATTERN: RAS asks "Who started the Shaka era?" - the standard accepted answer is **Kanishka (78 CE)**. Also remember: **Vikrama Samvat began in 57 BCE**, linked with king Vikramaditya of Ujjain.

Chapter 4: Gupta & the Southern Dynasties

The Gupta Empire (c. 320-550 CE)

The Guptas rose in Magadha. **Chandragupta I** (320 CE) started the **Gupta era** and gained importance through his marriage to the Lichchhavi princess **Kumaradevi**. The empire was truly built by his successors.

Ruler	Key Facts
Samudragupta (335-375 CE)	Called the **"Napoleon of India"** (V.A. Smith) for his conquests; the **Allahabad Prashasti** (Prayaga Prashasti), composed by his court poet **Harisena** on an Ashokan pillar, lists his campaigns
Chandragupta II - Vikramaditya (375-415 CE)	Defeated the Shakas of western India; peak of Gupta power; the Chinese pilgrim **Fa-Hien** visited India in his reign; tradition of the **Navaratnas** (nine gems) belongs to his court
Kumaragupta I (415-455 CE)	Founded **Nalanda Mahavihara** (university)

Ruler	Key Facts
Skandagupta (455-467 CE)	Last strong Gupta; repelled the **Huna** invasion; his Bhitari pillar inscription records this

Samudragupta's Conquests (from the Allahabad Prashasti)

- **Aryavarta** (north India): nine kings were uprooted and their kingdoms annexed.
- **Dakshinapatha** (south India): twelve kings were defeated but reinstated after submission (**grahana-moksha-anugraha** policy).
- Frontier states (Samatata, Kamarupa, Nepal, Kartripura) paid tribute; forest chiefs were made servants; foreign powers (Kushans, Shakas, Sri Lanka) sought friendship.
- Samudragupta was also a poet and musician - his coins show him playing the **veena**; he performed the **Ashvamedha** sacrifice.

Gupta Administration and the "Golden Age" Debate

- Administration was **less centralised** than the Mauryan: hereditary offices, land grants to officials and Brahmanas, and powerful village bodies grew. Land revenue was the main tax (**bhaga**, 1/6th normally); officers included the Kumaramatya class; the empire was divided into provinces (**bhukti**) under Uparikas, districts (**vishaya**) under Vishayapatis.
- **Science and learning**: **Aryabhata** (Aryabhatiya, 499 CE) explained the earth's rotation, eclipses scientifically, and gave a very accurate value of pi; **Varahamihira** wrote the Brihat Samhita and Pancha-Siddhantika on astronomy; **Brahmagupta** later systematised zero and negative numbers.
- Medicine: the tradition of **Charaka** (medicine) and **Sushruta** (surgery - Sushruta Samhita describes surgical operations and instruments) was preserved and studied.
- Literature: **Kalidasa** (Abhijnana Shakuntalam, Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha) - the greatest Sanskrit poet - belongs to this age; the Puranas took near-final shape; Sanskrit became the language of court and inscription.
- Art: the Gupta style set the classical standard - serene Buddha images (Sarnath Dharmarajika tradition), the Dashavatara temple at **Deogarh**, cave paintings at **Ajanta** (mostly Vakataka-Gupta age), and fine gold coins (dinars) of Samudragupta and Chandragupta II.
- Metallurgy: the **Iron Pillar at Mehrauli (Delhi)**, from Chandragupta II's time, has not rusted in over 1,600 years - proof of advanced iron technology.

EXAM TRAP: Fa-Hien came during **Chandragupta II**; Hiuen Tsang came much later, during **Harsha** (7th century CE). RAS swaps these two regularly. Also, Nalanda was founded by **Kumaragupta I**, not by Harsha (Harsha was a later patron).

The Deccan and South: Chalukyas, Pallavas, Cholas

Chalukyas of Badami (c. 543-753 CE)

- **Pulakeshin II** (609-642 CE) was the greatest Chalukya: he defeated **Harsha** on the banks of the **Narmada** (recorded in the **Aihole inscription** of his court poet **Ravikirti**), and fought the Pallavas; the Persian king Khusrau II exchanged embassies with him.
- Chalukya temples at **Aihole** (called a "cradle of Indian temple architecture"), **Badami** (rock-cut caves) and **Pattadakal** (now a UNESCO site; the Virupaksha temple there later inspired the Chola and Vijayanagara builders).
- The Western Chalukyas of Kalyani (later branch) developed the **Vesara** style; the king **Vikramaditya VI** started the Chalukya-Vikrama era (1076 CE); the scholars **Bilhana** and

Vijnaneshvara (Mitakshara) adorned his court.

Pallavas of Kanchi (c. 575-897 CE)

- **Mahendravarman I** began rock-cut cave temples; **Narasimhavarman I (Mamalla)** founded **Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram)** - famous for the **rathas** (monolithic chariot temples, the "Seven Pagodas") and he defeated Pulakeshin II, taking the title **Vatapikonda**.
- **Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)** built the **Shore Temple** at Mahabalipuram and the **Kailasanatha temple** at Kanchipuram - among the earliest structural stone temples of the south.
- Pallava rule saw the growth of the **Bhakti movement** of Alvar and Nayanar saints in the Tamil country.

Cholas - the Imperial Age (c. 850-1279 CE)

Ruler	Key Facts
Vijayalaya (850 CE)	Revived Chola power, captured Tanjore
Rajaraja I (985-1014 CE)	Conquered Kerala, northern Sri Lanka and the Maldives region; built the **Brihadishvara (Rajarajeshvara) Temple** at Thanjavur (1010 CE)
Rajendra I (1014-1044 CE)	Marched to the **Ganga** (title **Gangaikonda**), founded **Gangaikondacholapuram**; naval expedition against **Srivijaya** (South-East Asia); conquered the whole of Sri Lanka
Kulottunga I (1070-1122 CE)	United the Chola and Eastern Chalukya lines; sent trade embassies to China

- **Local self-government** is the Cholas' most-tested feature. Village assemblies: **Ur** (general village assembly), **Sabha/Mahasabha** (assembly of Brahmin villages, agrahara) and **Nagaram** (merchants' body).
- The **Uttaramerur inscriptions** (of Parantaka I) describe in detail how Sabha committee members (**variyam**) were chosen by a lottery system (**kudavolai** - names drawn from a pot), with qualifications and disqualifications listed - a remarkable early record of local democracy.
- **Brihadishvara Temple**: a Dravida masterpiece - its vimana rises about 60 m; built entirely of granite; famous for wall inscriptions recording temple administration, dancers and endowments.
- **Bronze art**: Chola bronze casting by the lost-wax process reached perfection - the **Nataraja** (Shiva as cosmic dancer) is the most famous image of Indian art.
- Administration: empire into mandalams, valanadus and nadus; land was carefully surveyed; officers were paid by land assignments; temples became centres of education, banking and employment.

PYQ PATTERN: Uttaramerur = village assembly rules + kudavolai lottery. Rajaraja = Brihadishvara at Thanjavur. Rajendra = Ganga expedition + Srivijaya naval raid. These three pairs answer most Chola questions.

Temple Architecture Styles Compared

Feature	Nagara (North)	Dravida (South)	Vesara (Deccan)
Tower (shikhara/vimana)	Curved, rising like a mountain peak (**shikhara**)	Stepped pyramid of storeys (**vimana**) over the sanctum only	Mix of both - Nagara shape with Dravida detail

Feature	Nagara (North)	Dravida (South)	Vesara (Deccan)
Gateway	Simple entrance	Towering **gopurams** at the complex entrances, often taller than the vimana	Moderate
Complex	Single temple focus	Large walled complex with tanks and halls, temple-town grows around it	Star-shaped (stellate) platform base in later works
Examples	Kandariya Mahadeva (Khajuraho), Sun Temple (Konark), Lingaraja (Bhubaneswar)	Brihadishvara (Thanjavur), Meenakshi (Madurai), Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)	Pattadakal temples, Hoysala temples at Belur-Halebid

Chapter 5: Indian Knowledge & Value System

Varna and Ashrama

- **Varna**: society was described as four orders - **Brahmana** (learning and priesthood), **Kshatriya** (rule and war), **Vaishya** (agriculture, cattle and trade), **Shudra** (service). Early texts present it as function-based; over centuries it hardened into birth-based hierarchy with many castes (jatis).
- **Ashrama**: a person's life was ideally divided into four stages of 25 years each:

Ashrama	Stage of Life	Main Duty
Brahmacharya	Student life	Celibate study under a guru
Grihastha	Householder	Marriage, family, earning, charity - supports all other stages
Vanaprastha	Forest-retirement	Gradual withdrawal, meditation
Sannyasa	Renunciation	Complete detachment, seeking moksha

MEMORY HOOK: The order is "B-G-V-S": first learn, then earn, then withdraw, then renounce. Grihastha is called the most important because the other three stages depend on the householder's support.

Purushartha - the Four Aims of Life

Aim	Meaning
Dharma	Duty, righteousness, moral order
Artha	Wealth and power, earned by right means
Kama	Pleasure and desire, fulfilled within dharma
Moksha	Liberation from rebirth - the highest aim

- Together they balance worldly life and spiritual freedom: Artha and Kama are valid only when guided by Dharma; Moksha is the final goal.

The Sixteen Sanskaras

Sanskaras are life-cycle sacraments that mark the stages of life from conception to death. Important ones for exams:

Sanskara	Stage
Garbhadhana, Pumsavana, Simantonnayana	Before birth (conception, rites for the unborn child)
Jatakarma	At birth
Namakarana	Naming the child
Annaprashana	First feeding of solid food
Chudakarana (Mundan)	First haircut
Upanayana	Sacred thread ceremony - start of education; the boy becomes **dvija** (twice-born)
Vivaha	Marriage
Antyeshti	Funeral rites (the last sanskara)

EXAM TRAP: **Upanayana** is the sanskara that begins formal education - not Namakarana. The count of sanskaras is traditionally **sixteen** (Shodasha Sanskara).

Indian Philosophy: The Six Orthodox Schools

The **shad-darshana** accept the authority of the Vedas (astika schools):

School	Founder / Key Figure	Core Idea
Nyaya	Gautama	Logic and correct knowledge; path to liberation through true reasoning
Vaisheshika	Kanada	Atomism - the world is made of atoms (anu) of earth, water, fire, air
Samkhya	Kapila	Oldest school; dualism of **Purusha** (soul) and **Prakriti** (nature); 25 elements
Yoga	Patanjali	Union through discipline of body and mind; the Yoga Sutras
Purva Mimamsa	Jaimini	Interpretation of Vedic ritual; dharma = performance of rites
Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	Badarayana (Vyasa)	Philosophy of the Upanishads; Brahman and Atman; later developed by Shankaracharya (Advaita)

- **Charvaka (Lokayata)** is the materialist, nastika school: it rejects the Vedas, God, soul after death and karma; perception is the only valid knowledge; "enjoy life while you live" is its popular summary.
- Buddhism and Jainism are also classed as **nastika** because they do not accept Vedic authority - the dividing line is acceptance of the Veda, **not** belief in God.

EXAM TRAP: "Nastika" does not mean atheist here - it means non-acceptance of Vedic authority. Samkhya is astika though its classical form gives God little role. RAS twists this point often.

The Ancient Education System

- **Gurukuls**: students lived with the guru, learned by memorisation, debate and service; education was oral; subjects included the Vedas, grammar, logic, medicine, warfare and arts depending on varna and aim.

- **Taxila (Takshashila)**: the oldest famous centre (6th century BCE onwards), in the north-west; students came to study under individual famous teachers rather than one university; tradition links **Chanakya** and **Panini** (the grammarian, author of Ashtadhyayi) with it; medicine and law were strong here.
- **Nalanda** (Bihar): founded by **Kumaragupta I** (5th century CE); a true residential university with thousands of students and teachers from across Asia; **Hiuen Tsang** studied here under **Shilabhadra**; great library (Dharmaganja); subjects: Buddhism, Vedas, logic, medicine, astronomy, grammar. It was destroyed by **Bakhtiyar Khalji's** invasion (c. 1193 CE).
- **Vikramashila** (Bihar): founded by the Pala king **Dharmapala** (8th-9th century CE); strong in Tantric Buddhism and logic; the scholar **Atisha** taught here before going to Tibet.
- **Valabhi** (Gujarat): a major centre under the Maitrakas, famous for Hinayana Buddhism, law and commerce subjects; praised by Hiuen Tsang and Itsing.
- Other centres: **Odantapuri** (Pala foundation), **Kanchi** (Pallava-age learning, ghatikas), **Ujjain** (astronomy), and temple colleges (mathas) of the south.

PYQ PATTERN: Match the university to the founder: Nalanda - Kumaragupta I (Gupta); Vikramashila - Dharmapala (Pala); Odantapuri - Gopala/Dharmapala age (Pala). Taxila has **no single founder** - the classic trap option.

Chapter 6: The Sultanate & Vijayanagara

The Delhi Sultanate (1206-1526)

Qutbuddin Aibak founded the Sultanate in 1206 after Muhammad Ghori's death. Five dynasties ruled from Delhi:

Dynasty	Period	Notable Rulers / Facts
Slave (Mamluk)	1206-1290	Aibak (founder, started Qutub Minar), **Iltutmish** (real organiser - capital Delhi, iqta system, silver tanka), Razia (only woman ruler of the Sultanate age), Balban (strong monarchy, court discipline)
Khalji	1290-1320	**Alauddin Khalji** - conquests of Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, and the Deccan (Malik Kafur); market and land reforms
Tughlaq	1320-1414	Ghiyasuddin (founder), **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (ambitious experiments), **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (welfare works, canals, new towns)
Sayyid	1414-1451	Founded by Khizr Khan; weak, limited near Delhi
Lodi	1451-1526	Afghan dynasty; Bahlul (founder), **Sikandar Lodi** (founded Agra, 1504), Ibrahim Lodi - defeated by Babur at **Panipat (1526)**

Alauddin Khalji's Reforms (1296-1316)

- **Land reforms**: land measured and taxed at **half of the produce** in the core (Doab) region; state took payment in cash; house and grazing taxes added; middlemen's (khuts, muqaddams) privileges cut.
- **Market control**: prices of grains, cloth, horses and slaves were **fixed by the state**; separate markets in Delhi; officials (Shahna-i-Mandi) policed weights; granaries stocked grain - the aim was to keep a huge army cheaply.
- **Military reforms**: permanent standing army paid in cash; **dagh** (branding of horses) and **chehra/huliya** (descriptive rolls of soldiers) to stop fraud.
- He was the first Sultan to separate religion from state policy in practice and declared the state's interest supreme.

Muhammad bin Tughlaq's Experiments (1325-1351)

He was learned and bold, but his schemes failed in execution:

- **Transfer of capital** from Delhi to **Devagiri (renamed Daulatabad)** - aimed at controlling the Deccan; the forced return migration caused great hardship.
- **Token currency**: issued brass/copper tokens equal in value to the silver tanka; the scheme collapsed because anyone could mint tokens at home; the state had to redeem them at heavy loss.
- **Doab taxation** raised during famine conditions - peasants revolted; later corrected with loans and wells.
- A planned **Khurasan expedition** was raised and disbanded, wasting money.

MEMORY HOOK: MBT's four ideas = capital shift, token money, Doab tax, Khurasan army. Learn them as a set; exam options usually swap one item with Firoz Shah's works (canals, towns like Firozabad, Hissar) - those belong to Firoz, not MBT.

Sultanate Administration and the Iqta System

- The Sultan was the centre; key ministers: **Wazir** (finance and general administration), **Ariz-i-Mumalik** (military), **Diwan-i-Insha** (royal correspondence), **Diwan-i-Risalat** (religious/foreign matters), Qazi-ul-Quzat (chief justice), and **Barids** (news reporters/spies).
- **Iqta**: a grant of land revenue of a territory to an officer (**iqtadar/muqti**) in return for maintaining troops and administering the area. Introduced systematically by **Iltutmish**, it was initially non-hereditary and transferable; under Firoz Shah it became hereditary - weakening central control.
- Land categories tested often: **Khalisa** (crown land, revenue direct to the Sultan's treasury), **Iqta** (assigned to officers), **Inam/Waqf** (granted to religious persons/institutions).
- Taxes: **kharaj** (land tax), **khams** (1/5 of war booty), **zakat** (religious tax on Muslims), **jizya** (tax on non-Muslims, imposed with varying strictness).

The Vijayanagara Empire (1336-1565 and after)

- Founded in **1336** by the brothers **Harihara and Bukka** (Sangama dynasty) under the guidance of the sage **Vidyaranya**, on the banks of the **Tungabhadra**; capital Vijayanagara (modern Hampi, Karnataka).
- Four dynasties ruled: **Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, Aravidu**.
- **Krishnadevaraya** (1509-1529, Tuluva) was the greatest ruler: he defeated the Bahmani successor states and Gajapatis of Odisha, built the Vittala temple additions and Hazara Rama temple, and was a scholar himself - his Telugu work **Amuktamalyada** is famous; his court hosted

the **Ashtadiggajas** (eight great Telugu poets, including Tenali Rama of later fame).

- Foreign travellers whose accounts are major sources: **Nicolo Conti** (Italian), **Abdur Razzaq** (Persian ambassador), **Domingo Paes** and **Fernao Nuniz** (Portuguese).
- Administration: king at the centre, provinces under **mandaleshvaras**, land tax and trade taxes as revenue; village assemblies continued; the empire fielded a large army with Portuguese-supplied horses imported through Goa.
- Culture: classic **Dravida architecture** raised to new heights - tall rayagopurams, kalyana mandapas with carved pillars (Vittala temple's musical pillars), the stone chariot at Hampi. Literature flourished in Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada and Tamil.
- **Battle of Talikota (1565)**: the combined armies of the Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar) defeated Vijayanagara under Aliya Rama Raya; the capital was sacked and abandoned; the empire lingered under the Aravidu dynasty from Penukonda and Chandragiri but never recovered.

EXAM TRAP: Talikota is also called the Battle of **Rakshasa-Tangadi** (village names). Do not confuse its date: **1565** - after Krishnadevaraya (died 1529), not during his reign.

Chapter 7: The Mughal Period

From Babur to Aurangzeb: Timeline

Emperor	Reign	Landmarks
Babur	1526-1530	Won **First Battle of Panipat (1526)** against Ibrahim Lodi using field artillery and the tulughma tactic; defeated Rana Sanga at **Khanwa (1527)**; wrote his memoir **Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)** in Turkish
Humayun	1530-1540, 1555-1556	Defeated by **Sher Shah Suri** at Chausa (1539) and Kannauj (1540); exiled; restored in 1555; died falling from the library stairs (1556)
Akbar	1556-1605	Crowned at Kalanaur under regent **Bairam Khan**; **Second Battle of Panipat (1556)** vs Hemu; built the empire and its systems
Jahangir	1605-1627	Reign of justice imagery (Chain of Justice); influence of **Nur Jahan**; painting reached its peak
Shah Jahan	1628-1658	Age of marble architecture - **Taj Mahal**, Red Fort and Jama Masjid of Delhi; war of succession among his sons (1657-58)
Aurangzeb	1658-1707	Won the succession war (Samugarh, 1658); longest reign; empire at its largest extent; Deccan wars and Maratha conflict; reimposed jizya (1679)

- The short **Suri interregnum (1540-1555)**: **Sher Shah Suri** was a brilliant administrator - he built the **GT Road** (Sadak-e-Azam, from Sonargaon to Peshawar), reformed currency (the silver **rupiya**), land measurement and revenue, dak (postal) runners and sarais. Humayun's tomb and later Mughal systems owe much to him. His tomb stands at **Sasaram**.

Mughal Administration

- **Central government**: the emperor was the pivot; main ministers/offices: **Vakil** (prime ministerial role, diminished after Bairam Khan), **Diwan/Wazir** (revenue and finance), **Mir Bakhshi** (military pay and mansab management), **Sadr-us-Sudur** (religious endowments and charity), **Mir Saman** (royal household and workshops), **Qazi-ul-Quzat** (chief justice).
- **Provincial structure**: empire divided into **subas** (provinces; 12 at Akbar's accession era - 15 by 1605, 21 under Aurangzeb), each with a **Subadar** (governor), a provincial Diwan, Bakhshi, Sadr and Qazi - deliberately checking each other. Subas contained **sarkars** (districts) with Faujdar (law and order) and Amalguzar (revenue); sarkars contained **parganas**, and the village was run by the muqaddam and the patwari (record-keeper).

Mansabdari System

- Introduced by **Akbar**: every officer held a rank (**mansab**) with two numbers - **Zat** (personal rank, fixed salary and status) and **Sawar** (number of horsemen to maintain).
- Ranks ranged from 10 to 10,000; princes held the highest. Payment was by **jagir** (land revenue assignment) or cash.
- Reforms to stop fraud: branding of horses (dagh) and descriptive rolls (chehra), reintroduced from Alauddin's practice.
- Under later emperors the jagir shortage (claims exceeding available land) became a structural crisis - the **jagir crisis** is a standard cause of decline.

Land Revenue: Zabt and Todar Mal

- **Raja Todar Mal**, Akbar's revenue minister, perfected the **Zabt system** (1580s): land was **measured** (with the bamboo jarib), classified by fertility (Polaj - cropped yearly; Parauti - left fallow a year or two; Chachar - fallow 3-4 years; Banjar - fallow 5+ years), and average produce of the last ten years (**dahsala**) was calculated; the state's share was generally **one-third** of the average, taken in cash at standard rates.
- Other methods in use: **Ghalla-bakhshi/Batai** (crop sharing), **Kankut** (appraisal), **Nasq** (group assessment).
- The **Ain-i-Akbari** of **Abul Fazl** records the zabt rates, administration and statistics of the empire - the most important single source for Akbar's reign. Abul Fazl also wrote the **Akbarnama** (official history).

Akbar's Policies

- **Sulh-i-Kul** ("peace with all"): policy of tolerance towards all religions - abolished the **pilgrimage tax (1563)** and **jizya (1564)**, appointed Hindus to the highest offices (Todar Mal, Man Singh, Birbal), married Rajput princesses and allied with Rajput states.
- Built the **Ibadat Khana** (1575, Fatehpur Sikri) for religious discussions; issued the **Mahzar (1579)** claiming authority in religious interpretation; in 1582 he proclaimed **Din-i-Ilahi (Tauhid-i-Ilahi)** - an ethical-spiritual order with very few adherents (Birbal is the famous Hindu member); it was not a new mass religion.
- Patron of arts: got the **Mahabharata translated into Persian (Razmnama)**, the Ramayana translated by **Badauni**, founded the imperial painting atelier; built **Fatehpur Sikri** (Buland

Darwaza, Panch Mahal, Salim Chishti's tomb).

Jizya: The Timeline to Remember

Step	Ruler
Abolished	**Akbar, 1564**
Reimposed	**Aurangzeb, 1679**
Abolished (after Aurangzeb's era decline)	Removed finally under the later Mughal Farrukhsiyar, formally 1720s in practice

Why the Empire Declined (in brief)

- **War of succession** in every generation drained the treasury and court unity.
- Aurangzeb's long **Deccan wars** overextended the empire; his religious policies alienated Rajputs, Marathas, Sikhs and Jats (Satnami, Jat and Sikh revolts rose in his reign).
- The **jagir crisis** and a bloated, corrupt mansabdari nobility divided into factions (Irani, Turani, Hindustani).
- Weak later emperors after 1707; invasions of **Nadir Shah (1739)** - who carried away the Peacock Throne and the Kohinoor - and **Ahmad Shah Abdali**; rise of regional powers (Marathas, Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad) and the English East India Company.

PYQ PATTERN: RAS favourite facts: Ain-i-Akbari = Abul Fazl; Zabt = Todar Mal; Zabt share = one-third; Mansab = Zat + Sawar; Sher Shah's coin = rupiya; GT Road = Sher Shah. Say them as fixed pairs.

Chapter 8: The Marathas

Shivaji (1630-1680) and the Making of Maratha Power

- **Chhatrapati Shivaji**, born at **Shivneri fort** (1630) to Shahaji Bhonsle and Jijabai, built a kingdom in the western Deccan hills. Guided early by his administrator **Dadaji Konddev** and inspired by saints like Tukaram and Ramdas (tradition), he captured Torna fort (1646) and built power fort by fort.
- He killed the Bijapuri general **Afzal Khan** (1659), outwitted the Mughal commander **Shaista Khan** in a night attack at Pune (1663), sacked **Surat** twice (1664, 1670), escaped from Mughal custody at **Agra (1666)**, and recovered his forts by 1670.
- **Coronation (1674)**: Shivaji was crowned at **Raigad** with full Vedic rites by the priest Gaga Bhatt, taking the title **Chhatrapati**. He died in 1680.

Shivaji's Administration

- Council of eight ministers - the **Ashtapradhan**:

Minister	Function
Peshwa	Chief minister (prime minister)
Amatya (Majumdar)	Finance and accounts
Sumant (Dabir)	Foreign affairs
Sachiv (Shurunavis)	Royal correspondence
Senapati (Sarnobat)	Commander-in-chief

Minister	Function
Mantri (Waqia-Navis)	Intelligence and records
Nyayadhish	Chief justice
Panditrao	Religious affairs and charity

- Ministers (except Nyayadhish and Panditrao) also held military commands; officials were paid in **cash**, not jagirs - a key Shivaji discipline.
- **Chauth**: one-fourth (25%) of the revenue of a territory, claimed in return for not raiding it / for protection.
- **Sardeshmukhi**: an additional 10% claimed as the hereditary right of the deshmukh (chief headman) of the land.
- **Guerrilla warfare (ganimi kava)**: light cavalry (bargirs - state-supplied horses; shiledars - own horses) striking supply lines and avoiding pitched battle, using hill forts as bases; Shivaji maintained over 300 forts and a navy on the Konkan coast (unusual for an Indian land power).

EXAM TRAP: Chauth = **1/4 (25%)**; Sardeshmukhi = extra **10%**. Exam options often reverse them or give Sardeshmukhi as 1/10th *instead* of saying extra - remember "chauth first (25), sardeshmukhi above it (10)".

After Shivaji: Resistance and the Peshwa Era

- **Sambhaji** (1680-89) was captured and executed by Aurangzeb; **Rajaram** continued resistance from Jinji; after 1707 the Maratha state split between **Shahu's** line at Satara and Tarabai's line at Kolhapur.
- Under Shahu, the **Peshwa** (chief minister) became the real ruler: **Balaji Vishwanath** (1713-20) made the office hereditary; **Baji Rao I** (1720-40) expanded Maratha power to the north ("from Attock to Cuttack" ambition) with brilliant cavalry raids; **Balaji Baji Rao (Nanasaheb)** (1740-61) saw the confederacy at its widest.
- The **Maratha Confederacy**: semi-independent chiefs owing allegiance to the Peshwa - **Scindia** (Gwalior), **Holkar** (Indore), **Gaekwad** (Baroda), **Bhonsle** (Nagpur), plus the Peshwa's own domain around Pune.

Third Battle of Panipat (14 January 1761)

- Maratha army under **Sadashivrao Bhau** (with Vishwasrao) faced **Ahmad Shah Abdali** (Durrani of Afghanistan), supported by Indian allies like Najib-ud-Daula and Shuja-ud-Daula of Awadh.
- Causes of defeat: over-extended supply lines and a huge non-combatant camp, starvation after Abdali cut supplies, loss of potential allies (Rajputs and Jats alienated - Suraj Mal withdrew), and Abdali's superior tactics and mobile artillery (zamburaks).
- The defeat killed a generation of Maratha leadership (Bhau and Vishwasrao died) and briefly halted expansion, though the Marathas recovered within a decade under **Madhav Rao I**. The deeper gainers were the British, whose rivals now stood weakened.

MEMORY HOOK: Panipat has three famous battles - **1526 (Babur), 1556 (Akbar's side vs Hemu), 1761 (Marathas vs Abdali)**. One field, three turning points of Indian history.

Chapter 9: Medieval Art, Literature, Music & Bhakti-Sufi

Indo-Islamic Architecture

New elements arrived: the **true arch**, the **dome**, **minarets**, and the use of mortar; Indian craftsmen adapted them with local skill.

Monument	Builder / Period	Note
Qutub Minar, Delhi	Started by Aibak, completed by Iltutmish	Tallest brick minaret; Alai Darwaza (Alauddin, 1311) added later - a gem of early Indo-Islamic work
Tughlaqabad & Siri	Tughlaq era; Siri by Alauddin	Fortified cities; utilitarian, sloping (batter) walls
Humayun's Tomb, Delhi (1565)	Built by his widow Haji Begum; architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas	First great **garden tomb (charbagh)** - the model of the Taj Mahal
Fatehpur Sikri (1571-85)	Akbar	Buland Darwaza (victory gate), Panch Mahal, Salim Chishti's tomb (white marble)
Taj Mahal, Agra (1632-53)	Shah Jahan, for Mumtaz Mahal; chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahauri (tradition)	Perfect charbagh tomb; pietra dura inlay work
Red Fort & Jama Masjid, Delhi	Shah Jahan	Peacock Throne was placed in the Diwan-i-Khas
Gol Gumbad, Bijapur	Muhammad Adil Shah (17th century)	One of the largest domes of its age; whispering gallery

- Key features to state: arches and domes replaced the trabeate (beam) method; **pietra dura** (inlay of semi-precious stones) and calligraphy decorated walls; minarets and vast courtyards marked mosques; overall effect was geometric and symmetrical.
- Temple building also continued in the medieval age - the Lingaraja and Jagannath temples (Odisha), Khajuraho group (Chandela, 10th-11th centuries, transition into early medieval), Sun Temple at Konark (13th century, Narasimhadeva I), and Hoysala temples with star-shaped platforms.

Painting

- **Mughal painting**: founded as an imperial atelier by **Humayun**, who brought Persian masters (Mir Sayyid Ali, Abdus Samad) from Persia; **Akbar** expanded it - projects included the illustrated **Hamzanama** and the Razmnama; Indian painters like Basawan and Daswanth rose.
- Under **Jahangir**, painting reached its height - naturalistic studies of birds, animals and flowers (master **Ustad Mansur**, titled Nadir-ul-Asr), fine portraits; Jahangir himself was a connoisseur who claims in his memoir to identify each painter's hand.
- **Shah Jahan's** age made painting more formal and courtly; **Aurangzeb** withdrew patronage, and painters migrated to regional courts.
- **Rajput painting**: bold colours, Krishna themes, court and hunting scenes - schools at Mewar, Bundi, Kishangarh (famous **Bani Thani** of Nihal Chand), Marwar and Amber-Jaipur.
- **Pahari painting** (hill states): the lyrical **Kangra school** (late 18th century) - delicate lines, cool colours, Radha-Krishna love themes; Basohli is the earlier, bolder Pahari style.

Literature of the Medieval Age

- **Persian** was the court language: Amir Khusrau's works, Ziauddin Barani's **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**, Abul Fazl's **Akbarnama** and **Ain-i-Akbari**, Badauni's critical history, Jahangir's **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** (memoir, in Persian), and Dara Shikoh's translations of the **Upanishads (Sirr-i-Akbar)** and his Majma-ul-Bahrain (comparison of Sufi and Vedantic ideas).
- Sanskrit continued: Kalhana's **Rajatarangini** (history of Kashmir, 12th century) is famous as an early true history; Jayadeva's **Gita Govinda** spread Krishna devotion.
- **Regional languages flowered** through Bhakti: Hindi (Kabir's dohas, Surdas's Sursagar, Tulsidas's **Ramcharitmanas** in Awadhi), Bengali (Chaitanya tradition and Vaishnava lyrics), Marathi (Jnaneshwar's **Jnaneshwari**, Eknath, Tukaram's abhangas), Punjabi (Guru Nanak's verses, later the Adi Granth, 1604), Assamese (Sankardev), Malayalam and Kannada devotional and court literature.
- **Amir Khusrau** (1253-1325) deserves a special line: court poet of the Sultanate, disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, called **Tuti-i-Hind** (Parrot of India); credited in tradition with the **qawwali**, khayal's seeds, new ragas and instruments - a symbol of composite culture.

Music

- **Tansen**, one of Akbar's Navaratnas, court musician from the court of Rewa; credited with ragas like Miyan ki Malhar and Miyan ki Todi; the **dhrupad** style dominated court music.
- **Khayal** developed later (its flowering is credited to the 18th-century court of Muhammad Shah, with Sadarang); the Sultanate-medieval tradition credits early forms to Amir Khusrau and the Sufi sama gatherings.
- Bhakti song traditions - kirtan, bhajan, abhang, qawwali at Sufi shrines - carried music to the common people in regional languages.

The Bhakti Movement

Bhakti (devotion to a personal God) rose early in the Tamil south and spread across India between the 12th and 17th centuries.

- **Roots**: the **Alvars** (Vaishnava saints, 12 in number; their hymns form the Nalayira Divya Prabandham) and **Nayanars** (Shaiva saints, 63 in number) of Tamil country (6th-9th centuries). Philosophers gave it doctrine: **Ramanuja** (Vishishtadvaita - qualified non-dualism, 11th-12th century), **Madhva** (Dvaita - dualism), **Vallabha** (Shuddhadvaita; founder of the Pushtimarga; Krishna devotion), **Nimbarka** and later **Chaitanya** in Bengal (Gaudiya Vaishnavism; sankirtan - public singing of Krishna's name).
- **Ramananda** (14th-15th century, Prayag/Varanasi) carried Bhakti to north India and broke caste barriers - his disciples included **Kabir** (a weaver), **Ravidas** (a cobbler), **Dhanna** (a Jat peasant) and **Sena** (a barber).
- **Kabir** (15th-16th century): preached one God beyond Hindu-Muslim division, attacked ritual and caste in sharp dohas; his verses were included in the **Guru Granth Sahib**, the Bijak and the Kabir Granthavali.
- **Guru Nanak** (1469-1539), founder of Sikhism: taught one formless God (Ik Onkar), rejected caste and ritual, started **langar** (community kitchen) and sangat (congregation); his successors built the faith - Guru Arjan compiled the Adi Granth (1604), Guru Gobind Singh founded the **Khalsa (1699)** and made the Granth the eternal Guru.
- Other leading names: **Surdas** (Krishna bhakti, blind poet of Braj), **Tulsidas** (Ram devotion), **Mirabai** (Rajput princess, Krishna devotion in Rajasthani-Braj songs), **Sankardev** (Assam, Ekasarana dharma), **Jnaneshwar and Tukaram** (Maharashtra, Varkari tradition centred on Vithoba of Pandharpur).

StuDy

The Sufi Movement

- **Sufism** is the mystical path within Islam - love of God, inner purity, service of humanity, and guidance of a master (pir/murshid) to disciples (murids); orders are called **silsilas**.
- **Chishti silsila**: founded in India by **Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti**, who settled at **Ajmer** (died 1236; his dargah is among India's most visited shrines). Successors: Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Punjab - his verses are in the Guru Granth Sahib), and **Nizamuddin Auliya** of Delhi (1238-1325), the most beloved Chishti, teacher of Amir Khusrau; the Chishtis kept distance from royal courts and served the poor.
- **Suhrawardi silsila**: centred at Multan under **Bahauddin Zakariya**; unlike the Chishtis, they accepted state patronage and wealth.
- Other orders: **Qadiri** (Dara Shikoh was its disciple under Mian Mir), **Naqshbandi** (orthodox; Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi opposed Akbar's liberalism), Firdausi and Shattari in Bihar and the Deccan.

Contribution of Bhakti and Sufi Movements

- Both taught in the **language of the people**, growing regional literatures and music (kirtan, qawwali).
- Both attacked **caste and empty ritual**, welcomed low-caste and women followers, and stressed the **oneness of God and equality of humans**.
- Their saints and shrines became **meeting grounds of Hindu and Muslim culture** - the shared composite (Ganga-Jamuni) culture: Hindus visit Ajmer Sharif; Muslims join in Holi and village saint festivals.
- They humanised religion, encouraged charity (langar, khanqah kitchens), and prepared the moral atmosphere for reformers of later centuries.

EXAM TRAP: Muinuddin Chishti = **Ajmer** (Chishti founder in India); Nizamuddin Auliya = **Delhi** (Chishti); Bahauddin Zakariya = **Multan** (Suhrawardi). Ramanuja = Vishishtadvaita; Shankara (earlier, 8th century) = Advaita; Madhva = Dvaita. Vedanta-school matching is a guaranteed RAS pattern.

Chapter 10: British Imperialism & Resistance

How the Company Became Ruler

The English East India Company (chartered 1600) defeated its European rivals (the French in the Carnatic Wars) and then Indian powers step by step: **Plassey (1757)** - Clive defeated Siraj-ud-Daula of Bengal with Mir Jafar's betrayal; **Buxar (1764)** - the Company defeated the combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah Alam II; the **Treaty of Allahabad (1765)** gave the Company the **Diwani** (revenue rights) of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.

Anglo-Mysore Wars

War	Years	Main Result
First	1767-69	Haider Ali held his own; Treaty of Madras restored conquests
Second	1780-84	Haider died (1782); Tipu continued; Treaty of Mangalore (1784) - status quo

War	Years	Main Result
Third	1790-92	**Tipu Sultan** lost half his territory; Treaty of Seringapatam; heavy indemnity
Fourth	1799	Tipu died defending **Seringapatam**; Mysore became a subsidiary state

Anglo-Maratha Wars

War	Years	Main Result
First	1775-82	Treaty of Salbai (1782) - status quo; Marathas remained strong
Second	1803-05	Bhonsle and Scindia defeated; Orissa and north Indian territories ceded
Third	1817-18	Peshwa **Baji Rao II** defeated and pensioned off; Maratha power ended; Bombay Presidency expanded

Anglo-Sikh Wars

War	Years	Main Result
First	1845-46	After Ranjit Singh's death (1839) disorder grew; Sikhs lost territory; a British Resident placed at Lahore
Second	1848-49	**Punjab annexed (1849)** by Dalhousie; Maharaja Dalip Singh pensioned; the **Kohinoor** passed to the British

Annexation Policies

- **Subsidiary Alliance** (systematised by **Lord Wellesley**, 1798): the Indian ruler kept a British force in his state, paid for it (in money or territory), accepted a British Resident, and could not employ other Europeans or make war/alliances freely. First accepted by the **Nizam of Hyderabad (1798)**; then Awadh, Mysore, Tanjore, the Peshwa and others.
- **Doctrine of Lapse** (applied most aggressively by **Lord Dalhousie**): if a ruler of a dependent state died without a natural male heir, the state "lapsed" to the Company - adoption was not recognised. States annexed: **Satara (1848, the first)**, Jaitpur, Sambalpur, Jhansi (1853), Nagpur (1854).
- **Awadh (1856)** was annexed on the charge of **misgovernance**, not lapse - a distinction RAS tests carefully.

EXAM TRAP: Jhansi = Lapse; Awadh = misrule. And the first Lapse victim was **Satara (1848)**, not Jhansi.

Land Settlements

System	Where / By Whom	Settlement With	State Demand
Permanent Settlement (1793)	Bengal, Bihar, parts of Orissa and Madras; **Lord Cornwallis**	Zamindars made owners	Fixed forever (about 10/11th of the rental taken as revenue); zamindars could be dispossessed for default (sunset law)
Ryotwari	Madras and Bombay; **Thomas Munro** and Alexander Read	The individual ryot (cultivator)	High (about half the net produce in theory), revised every 20-30 years; no middlemen
Mahalwari	North-Western Provinces, Punjab, parts of central India; Holt Mackenzie / William Bentinck era	The village community (mahal) jointly	High demand, periodically revised; village headman collected

Economic Policies and the Drain Theory

- The Company first drained Bengal's wealth (after 1765 revenues bought Indian goods for export - an unrequited transfer), then turned India into a **supplier of raw material** and a **market for British manufactures**: machine-made Lancashire cloth flooded India while Indian textile exports were burdened; traditional handicrafts declined (**deindustrialisation**) - Dhaka's famed muslin industry collapsed.
- **Dadabhai Naoroji** gave the classic critique in **"Poverty and Un-British Rule in India" (1901)** - the **Drain Theory**: salaries and pensions of British officials, interest on loans, profits and "home charges" flowed to Britain without equivalent return, impoverishing India. R.C. Dutt's Economic History of India supported the critique.
- Other economic changes: commercialisation of agriculture (opium, indigo, cotton, tea plantations with coerced labour), railways (first train **Bombay-Thane, 1853, under Dalhousie**), telegraph (1854) and modern postal system - built mainly for British trade and control, though they later aided Indian unity.

Administrative Structure in Brief

- **Regulating Act (1773)**: Governor of Bengal became **Governor-General of Bengal** (Warren Hastings the first); a Supreme Court set up at Calcutta.
- **Pitt's India Act (1784)**: dual control - Court of Directors (Company) plus a Board of Control (British government).
- **Charter Act of 1833**: Governor-General of Bengal became **Governor-General of India** (William Bentinck the first); the Company lost its trade monopoly entirely; law-making centralised.
- **Charter Act of 1853**: competitive examination for the civil services announced in principle (implemented from 1855; exam held in London).
- Revenue and police systems rested on the District Collector/Magistrate; the **Indian Civil Service** became the "steel frame" of the Raj; Indians were largely excluded from higher posts; the army relied on Indian sepoys under British officers.

MEMORY HOOK: Wars as pairs - Mysore: Haider-Tipu, 4 wars, Tipu dies 1799. Marathas: 3 wars, end 1818. Sikhs: 2 wars, Punjab annexed 1849. This "4-3-2" pattern fixes most of the Anglo-Indian war questions.

Chapter 11: The Revolt of 1857 & After

Causes of the Revolt

- **Political**: Dalhousie's Lapse annexations (Jhansi, Nagpur, Satara), Awadh's annexation (1856) which hurt its taluqdars and sepoys (many sepoys came from Awadh), pension stoppages (Nana Sahib denied the Peshwa's pension), and the humiliation of the Mughal house.
- **Economic**: heavy land revenue, destruction of handicrafts, unemployment of artisans and soldiers of annexed states.
- **Social-religious**: missionary activity and reform laws (abolition of sati 1829, Widow Remarriage Act 1856) were misread as attacks on religion; racial arrogance of the British.
- **Military**: sepoys' low pay, the General Service Enlistment Act (1856) requiring overseas service (crossing the sea was religiously sensitive), and the immediate spark - the **greased cartridges** of the new Enfield rifle, rumoured to be coated with cow and pig fat, offensive to Hindus and Muslims alike.

The Outbreak and Spread

- **29 March 1857**: **Mangal Pandey** of the 34th Native Infantry attacked British officers at **Barrackpore**; he was hanged on 8 April.
- **10 May 1857**: sepoys at **Meerut** rose, freed their jailed comrades and marched to Delhi.
- **11 May 1857**: Delhi was captured; the aged **Bahadur Shah Zafar II** was proclaimed Emperor of India - giving the revolt an all-India symbol.

Centres and Leaders

Centre	Leader(s)	British Officer Who Suppressed / Notes
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar; military command by **Bakht Khan**	Delhi recaptured by John Nicholson (died in the assault) and others, Sept 1857; Zafar exiled to **Rangoon**
Kanpur	**Nana Sahib** (adopted son of Baji Rao II) with **Tantia Tope** and Azimullah	Campbell recaptured Kanpur; Tantia Tope fought on in central India till captured and hanged (1859)
Lucknow (Awadh)	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** (for her son Birjis Qadir); Maulvi Ahmadullah also active	Lucknow residency defended; city finally taken by Campbell in March 1858
Jhansi	**Rani Lakshmibai**	Hugh Rose campaigned in central India; the Rani died fighting near Gwalior (June 1858); Rose called her the most dangerous of the rebel leaders (in praise of her bravery)
Arrah (Bihar)	**Kunwar Singh** (80-year-old zamindar of Jagdishpur)	Fought brilliantly despite age; died of wounds in April 1858
Bareilly	**Khan Bahadur Khan**	Rohilkhand centre; suppressed by Campbell
Faizabad / Awadh countryside	Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah	Known as the "Maulvi of Faizabad"

- Large parts of India stayed quiet: Punjab, the south, Bengal's east, and the big princely states (Hyderabad, Gwalior's Scindia, Patiala, Jind) actively helped the British; Sikh and Gurkha soldiers aided the recapture of Delhi.

Consequences

- **Government of India Act 1858**: rule passed from the Company to the **British Crown**; the Governor-General became the **Viceroy** (Lord Canning the first Viceroy); a Secretary of State for India was created in London.
- **Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1 November 1858, Allahabad)**: promised no more annexations, respect for treaties with princes, non-interference in religion, and equal treatment - called the "Magna Carta of India" in popular phrasing.
- **Army reorganisation**: ratio of British to Indian soldiers raised; artillery kept in British hands; recruitment shifted to Punjab, Nepal and the frontier (the "martial races" policy).
- Policy after 1857 became cautious and conservative: alliance with princes and landlords, social reform slowed, and "divide and rule" sharpened with separate treatment of communities.

The Nature Debate

Historians disagree: British writers called it a mere **"Sepoy Mutiny"**; **V.D. Savarkar** (1909) called it the **"First War of Indian Independence"**; R.C. Majumdar held it was neither first, nor national, nor a war of independence in full sense. The balanced exam position: it began as a sepoy rising but grew into a widespread popular revolt in north and central India, though without an all-India organisation or a common national plan.

PYQ PATTERN: Match centre to leader: Delhi-Bakht Khan (real command), Kanpur-Nana Sahib, Lucknow-Begum Hazrat Mahal, Jhansi-Lakshmibai, Arrah-Kunwar Singh, Bareilly-Khan Bahadur Khan. This single table is asked again and again.

Chapter 12: The National Movement

Socio-Religious Reform Movements

These movements attacked social evils and revived self-respect - the seed-bed of nationalism.

Movement / Organisation	Founder / Leader (Year)	Main Thrust
Brahmo Samaj	**Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (1828)	One God, against sati, idol worship and caste rigidity; Roy campaigned for the abolition of sati (1829)
Prarthana Samaj	Atmaram Pandurang (1867), later M.G. Ranade	Maharashtra's prayer-and-reform movement on Brahmo lines
Arya Samaj	**Swami Dayananda Saraswati** (1875)	"Back to the Vedas"; against idolatry and caste by birth; Shuddhi movement; DAV schools
Ramakrishna Mission	**Swami Vivekananda** (1897)	Service of man as worship of God ("Daridra Narayana"); Vivekananda's Chicago speech (1893) won world attention
Theosophical Society	Blavatsky & Olcott (1875, New York); Annie Besant in India	Pride in Indian religion and philosophy; Besant founded the Central Hindu College, Banaras (1898)

Movement / Organisation	Founder / Leader (Year)	Main Thrust
Aligarh Movement	**Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**	Modern English education for Muslims; Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College (1875) - later Aligarh Muslim University
Satyashodhak Samaj	**Jyotiba Phule** (1873)	Attacked Brahmin dominance and caste; education for Shudras and women; Savitribai Phule ran girls' schools
Self-Respect Movement	E.V. Ramaswami "Periyar" (1925)	Tamil Nadu; rationalism, against caste and priestcraft

The Indian National Congress and the Early Phase

- **INC founded 1885**: first session at **Bombay**, president **Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee**, 72 delegates; A.O. Hume (retired British civil servant) was its general secretary; Viceroy Dufferin era. The "safety valve" theory debates its origin, but it quickly became India's national platform.
- **Moderates (1885-1905)**: Dadabhai Naoroji, G.K. Gokhale, Surendranath Banerjea, Pherozeshah Mehta - believed in petitions, prayers and constitutional pressure ("3P" method); their economic critique (Drain Theory) exposed British rule intellectually.
- **Extremists**: **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, **Bipin Chandra Pal**, **Lala Lajpat Rai** ("Lal-Bal-Pal") and Aurobindo - demanded Swaraj (self-rule), used boycott, swadeshi, national education and passive resistance. Tilak's slogan: **"Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it"**; he popularised the Ganapati and Shivaji festivals and edited **Kesari** (Marathi) and Mahratta.
- **Partition of Bengal (1905)**: Viceroy **Lord Curzon** divided Bengal (officially for administration) - 16 October 1905 was observed as a day of mourning/rakhi; the **Swadeshi Movement** (boycott of foreign cloth, national schools, swadeshi shops) was born, centred in Bengal and spread by Tilak elsewhere.
- **Surat Split (1907)**: Congress divided into Moderates and Extremists at Surat; reunited only at Lucknow (1916).
- **Muslim League founded 1906** at Dhaka (Aga Khan and Nawab Salimullah; Mohsin-ul-Mulk active) - separate electorates followed in the **Morley-Minto Reforms (1909)**.
- **Lucknow Pact (1916)**: Congress reunion + Congress-League joint scheme; the same year Tilak and **Annie Besant** launched **Home Rule Leagues** (1916).

The Gandhian Era (1915-1947)

Gandhi returned from South Africa in **January 1915** (he had developed **Satyagraha** there - truth-force, non-violent resistance). His ashrams (Sabarmati, 1917) and methods - non-cooperation, boycott, marches, fasts - turned nationalism into a mass movement.

Gandhian Movements Table

Movement	Years	Trigger / Course / Result
Champaran Satyagraha	1917	Bihar indigo peasants forced into **tinkathia** system (15% land under indigo); Gandhi's first Indian satyagraha; tinkathia abolished
Ahmedabad Mill Strike	1918	Workers vs mill owners over plague bonus; Gandhi's first fast in India

Movement	Years	Trigger / Course / Result
Kheda Satyagraha	1918	Gujarat peasants unable to pay revenue after crop failure; revenue collection suspended
Rowlatt Satyagraha	1919	Protest against the Rowlatt (Black) Act; led to the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** (13 April 1919, Amritsar, General Dyer) and nationwide shock
Non-Cooperation Movement	1920-22	Combined with the Khilafat cause; boycott of foreign cloth, titles, courts and colleges; withdrawn by Gandhi after the **Chauri Chaura incident** (5 Feb 1922) in which a mob killed policemen
Civil Disobedience Movement	1930-34	Began with the **Dandi March** (12 March - 6 April 1930): Gandhi walked 240 miles from Sabarmati to Dandi and broke the salt law; boycotts, no-tax campaigns, women participated widely (Sarojini Naidu led the Dharsana raid); Gandhi-Irwin Pact (1931), Second Round Table Conference (1931) failed; movement resumed and was withdrawn in 1934
Quit India Movement	1942	**8 August 1942**, Bombay (Gowalia Tank) - Gandhi's call **"Do or Die"**; leaders arrested at once; people rose leaderless with sabotage of railways and telegraph lines; parallel governments at Ballia and Tamluk (Jatiya Sarkar); Jayaprakash Narayan and Aruna Asaf Ali active underground

- Other landmarks: **Poona Pact (1932)** - after the Communal Award gave separate electorates to the Depressed Classes, Gandhi's fast led to an agreement with **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**: joint electorates with reserved seats. **Congress Socialist Party** (1934) - Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva. The **Government of India Act 1935** gave provincial autonomy; Congress ministries were formed in 1937 and resigned in 1939 when India was dragged into WWII without consent.

The Revolutionary Movement

- Early phase: **Anushilan Samiti** and Jugantar (Bengal), the **Ghadar Party** (1913, San Francisco - Lala Hardayal and Sohan Singh Bhakna) among Punjabi emigrants, and Khudiram Bose's Muzaffarpur bomb (1908).
- **HRA (1924)** - Hindustan Republican Association (Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqullah Khan); the **Kakori train dacoity (1925)** case hanged Bismil, Ashfaqullah, Roshan Singh and Rajendra Lahiri.
- **HSRA (1928)** - the HRA reorganised as the Hindustan **Socialist** Republican Association at Delhi; leaders **Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad, Sukhdev, Rajguru**. Acts: shooting of Saunders (1928) to avenge Lala Lajpat Rai's death after the anti-Simon lathi charge; **Assembly Bomb Case (8 April 1929)** - Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw harmless bombs "to make the deaf hear" and courted arrest; **23 March 1931** - Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev were hanged in the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

- **Chittagong Armoury Raid (1930)**: **Surya Sen** ("Masterda") and associates (including Kalpana Dutta and Pritilata Waddedar) seized the armouries of Chittagong and proclaimed a provisional revolutionary government.

MEMORY HOOK: Kakori = HRA, 1925. Assembly bomb = HSRA, 1929. Chittagong raid = Surya Sen, 1930. Three events, three years, three groups - the classic confusion set.

INA and Subhas Chandra Bose

- **Subhas Chandra Bose**: brilliant ICS officer who resigned (1921), became Congress president at Haripura (1938) and Tripuri (1939), resigned after differences with Gandhi and founded the **Forward Bloc (1939)**.
- He escaped from Calcutta (1941) to Berlin, then reached Singapore (1943) and took command of the **Indian National Army (INA/Azad Hind Fauj)** first organised by Captain Mohan Singh with Japanese support. Bose formed the **Provisional Government of Azad Hind (21 October 1943, Singapore)**, gave the calls **"Jai Hind"** and **"Delhi Chalo"**, and raised the women's **Rani Jhansi Regiment** under Lakshmi Swaminathan (Sehgal).
- INA troops fought at Imphal-Kohima (1944); the campaign failed as Japan lost the war. Bose is believed to have died in an air crash at Taihoku (Taipei) on **18 August 1945**, though controversy continues.
- **INA Trials (Red Fort, 1945-46)**: the British tried INA officers **Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Sehgal and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon** - a Hindu, Muslim and Sikh together became a national symbol; Congress (Bhula Bhai Desai leading the defence) and the public backed them; sentences were remitted. The **Royal Indian Navy mutiny (February 1946, Bombay)** showed even the armed forces were restless - both events shook British confidence in holding India.

Regional and Other Movements (in brief)

- **Peasant movements**: Eka movement (UP, 1921), Bardoli Satyagraha (1928, led by **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** - who earned the title "Sardar" from Bardoli's women), All India Kisan Sabha (1936), Tebhaga (Bengal, 1946) and Telangana (1946-51).
- **Tribal risings** continued from the colonial economy's pressure: Santhal (1855), Munda under **Birsa Munda** (Ulgulan, 1899-1900), and many forest satyagrahas.
- **Workers**: AITUC founded (1920); great textile and railway strikes of the 1920s; Meerut Conspiracy Case (1929) against communist and labour leaders.

Communal Politics and Partition

- Separate electorates (1909) institutionalised communal politics; the **Muslim League's Lahore Resolution (1940)** demanded separate Muslim state(s); Jinnah's **Direct Action Day (16 August 1946)** triggered the Great Calcutta Killings.
- **Cabinet Mission (1946)** proposed a three-tier federation; the League rejected the interim arrangement; a Congress-led Interim Government under **Jawaharlal Nehru** took office in September 1946 while the **Constituent Assembly** first met on **9 December 1946** (Dr. Rajendra Prasad president; Jinnah's League initially boycotted).
- **Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947)** accepted partition; the **Indian Independence Act (July 1947)** created two dominions. **India became free on 15 August 1947** and Pakistan on 14 August; Punjab and Bengal were partitioned amid massive violence and migration.

EXAM TRAP: Home Rule = 1916 (Tilak + Besant). Khilafat joined Non-Cooperation, not Civil Disobedience. Dandi March = 1930 (a Civil Disobedience start, not a separate "Salt Satyagraha movement"). INA formed first by **Mohan Singh**; Bose revived and led it from 1943.

Chapter 13: Nation Building 1947-2000

Integration of the Princely States

- At independence there were **562 princely states**. The **States Ministry** under **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** with secretary **V.P. Menon** persuaded rulers to sign the **Instrument of Accession** (defence, foreign affairs, communications) before 15 August 1947 - a mostly bloodless triumph that earned Patel the title **"Iron Man of India"**. The book *The Story of the Integration of the Indian States* is by V.P. Menon.
- Three hold-outs: **Junagadh** (Nawab wanted Pakistan; a plebiscite in 1948 confirmed India), **Hyderabad** (Nizam held out; **Operation Polo**, police action, September 1948), **Kashmir** (Maharaja Hari Singh signed accession on **26 October 1947** after a tribal invasion backed by Pakistan; a ceasefire came in 1949).

Reorganisation of States

- Linguistic states were demanded early; after **Potti Sriramulu's** fast-unto-death, **Andhra State** was created for Telugu speakers in 1953.
- **States Reorganisation Commission (1953)**, chaired by **Fazal Ali** (members H.N. Kunzru and K.M. Panikkar), recommended language-based reorganisation with safeguards.
- **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**: from 1 November 1956 India had **14 states and 6 Union Territories**, abolishing the old Part A/B/C classification.
- Later milestones: Bombay split into **Maharashtra and Gujarat (1960)**; **Nagaland (1963)**; Punjab divided - **Haryana and Himachal (1966)**; north-eastern states in 1971-72 and later; **Goa became a state in 1987**.

Nehruvian Institutional Building

- **Planning Commission (1950)**: created by a cabinet resolution (not a constitutional body), chaired by the Prime Minister, to prepare **Five-Year Plans** through the National Development Council (1952).
- Scientific and technical institutions: **CSIR** (founded 1942, expanded after 1947), the first **IIT at Kharagpur (1951)** followed by Bombay, Madras, Kanpur, Delhi; the **UGC (1953)**; atomic energy under **Homi J. Bhabha**; the Indian Statistical Institute under P.C. Mahalanobis, architect of the Second Plan's heavy-industry model.
- Democratic foundations: first general elections (1951-52) under the new Constitution (adopted 26 November 1949, in force **26 January 1950**) with universal adult franchise - a bold experiment for a largely poor and illiterate nation; independent judiciary, Election Commission under **Sukumar Sen**.

Five-Year Plans - One Table

Plan	Period	Focus / Note
First	1951-56	Agriculture, irrigation, community development (Harrod-Domar model)

Plan	Period	Focus / Note
Second	1956-61	**Mahalanobis model** - heavy industries, steel plants (Bhilai, Durgapur, Rourkela)
Third	1961-66	Self-reliant economy; hit by the 1962 and 1965 wars and drought
Plan Holiday	1966-69	Three annual plans
Fourth	1969-74	Growth with stability; bank nationalisation (1969)
Fifth	1974-79	**Garibi Hatao** - poverty removal (terminated early in 1978)
Sixth	1980-85	Poverty alleviation, IRDP; Seventh (1985-90) - growth and modernisation, Rajiv-era technology missions
Eighth	1992-97	First plan of the liberalisation era (after two annual plans 1990-92)

Economic Reforms of 1991

- Trigger: a severe **balance of payments crisis** (1991) - reserves covered barely two weeks of imports, worsened by the Gulf War.
- The government of **P.V. Narasimha Rao** with Finance Minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh** launched **LPG - Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation**: industrial licensing largely abolished, rupee devalued (July 1991), trade opened, foreign investment welcomed, public sector disinvestment begun. The shift moved India from about 3.5% "Hindu rate of growth" to sustained higher growth in later decades.

Science, Technology and the Great Revolutions

- **Atomic energy**: **Atomic Energy Commission (1948)** chaired by **Homi Bhabha**; Department of Atomic Energy (1954); **Apsara (1956)** - Asia's first research reactor at Trombay; first peaceful nuclear explosion at **Pokhran (1974, "Smiling Buddha")**; Pokhran-II tests (1998).
- **Space programme**: **INCOSPAR (1962)** under **Vikram Sarabhai**; **ISRO founded 1969**; first satellite **Aryabhata (1975)** launched with Soviet help; **Rohini (1980)** placed by India's own **SLV-3** (project led by A.P.J. Abdul Kalam); INSAT and IRS satellite series followed; Thumba (Kerala) was the first launching station (1963).
- **Green Revolution** (from 1966-67): high-yielding wheat and rice varieties, chemical fertilisers and irrigation, led in India by **M.S. Swaminathan** (working with Norman Borlaug's strains); Punjab, Haryana and western UP led; India became self-sufficient in foodgrains.
- **White Revolution (Operation Flood, from 1970)**: dairy cooperatives on the **Amul** model, led by **Verghese Kurien**; made India the world's largest milk producer by the late 1990s.
- Defence and technology: integrated missile programme (1983) under Kalam (Prithvi, Agni series); supercomputer **PARAM (1991)** by C-DAC after technology denial; the IT/software boom of the 1990s seeded India's services-led growth.

MEMORY HOOK: Dates chain for nation building: **1948 AEC, 1950 Planning Commission, 1951 IIT Kharagpur, 1956 States Reorganisation, 1969 ISRO, 1975 Aryabhata, 1991 reforms**. Say it as a rising ladder - 48, 50, 51, 56, 69, 75, 91.

PYQ PATTERN: Patel + Menon = integration; Fazal Ali = states reorganisation; Mahalanobis = Second Plan; Bhabha = atomic energy; Sarabhai = space; Swaminathan = Green Revolution; Kurien = White Revolution. These seven pairs close this chapter in almost every paper.

StuDy